

# SEEWA

Empowering the Next Generation

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## Orientation Guide

Your first steps as a SEEWA volunteer

*"Empowering the Next Generation"*

# Welcome, New Volunteer!

Congratulations on joining SEEWA! This orientation guide will walk you through your first days as a volunteer — from onboarding to your first field activity. Read this alongside the Volunteer Handbook for a complete picture.

## Your First Week Checklist:

- Read the Volunteer Handbook
- Complete this Orientation Guide
- Join the SEEWA WhatsApp group
- Meet your Program Coordinator
- Attend an orientation session (virtual or in-person)
- Receive your Volunteer ID
- Shadow an experienced volunteer on your first activity

## Quick Overview: Who We Are

SEEWA is a women-led organization working to empower underprivileged communities through education, livelihoods, and development. Founded by **Dr. Jyothi Para** (Honorary Doctorate, The American University, USA), we operate across India with 4 core programs:

| Program | Focus                                | Example Activity                                           |
|---------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| WEE     | Women entrepreneurship & empowerment | Crochet workshops, health camps, Stand Up India drives     |
| YUVA    | Youth empowerment & education        | POSH/POCSO awareness, life skills training, career prep    |
| PRERNA  | Marketplace for women entrepreneurs  | Exhibition at SVM Grand, product mentorship, digital sales |
| CONNECT | NGO collaboration & community        | DISHA partnership, Pride of Hyderabad, volunteer drives    |

# Your Onboarding Journey

## Step 1: Application & Acceptance

You've already completed this! Your application was reviewed by the program team and you've been accepted as a SEEWA volunteer. Your acceptance email contains your Volunteer ID number and assigned Program Coordinator's contact details.

## Step 2: Orientation Session

Within your first week, you'll attend a 60-90 minute orientation session (virtual or at our Hyderabad office). This covers:

- SEEWA's history, mission, and current programs
- Introduction to your program team and fellow volunteers
- Overview of current activities and upcoming events
- Safety protocols and code of conduct walkthrough
- Q&A; with your Program Coordinator

## Step 3: Shadow & Learn

Your first field activity will be alongside an experienced volunteer or coordinator. This 'shadow session' lets you observe, ask questions, and understand how SEEWA operates on the ground before taking on responsibilities independently.

## Step 4: Independent Volunteering

After your shadow session, you'll begin contributing independently within your role. Your coordinator remains available for guidance at all times via WhatsApp or phone.

# What to Expect in the Field

## If you're a Field Volunteer (WEE/Yuva):

- You'll visit communities in Hyderabad and surrounding areas
- Activities include facilitating workshops, distributing materials, and documenting outcomes
- Dress comfortably and modestly — you'll be visiting homes and community centers
- Carry water, sunscreen, and your volunteer ID
- Typical session: 2-4 hours including travel

## If you're a Business Mentor (WEE/Prerna):

- You'll be matched with 1-3 women entrepreneurs from SEEWA's network of 120+ members
- Sessions can be virtual (Zoom/WhatsApp video) or in-person at SEEWA events
- Topics: business planning, pricing strategy, marketing, financial management, MSME registration
- Typical commitment: 1-2 calls per week + occasional Prerna marketplace attendance

## If you're an Education Volunteer (Yuva):

- You'll teach in schools, colleges, or community centers
- Topics: adult literacy, digital skills, life skills, POSH/POCSO awareness
- SEEWA provides training materials and presentation templates
- Sessions are typically 1-2 hours, scheduled around school/college timings

## If you're a Health Volunteer:

- You'll assist at community health camps (typically monthly)
- Activities: registration, patient flow management, health education, follow-up coordination
- Medical professionals lead clinical activities — you provide logistical support
- Camps include Ayurvedic wellness, nutrition counseling, and preventive healthcare

## Do's and Don'ts

| DO                                         | DON'T                                               |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Arrive on time and prepared                | Don't make promises you can't keep to beneficiaries |
| Listen more than you speak                 | Don't share beneficiary photos without consent      |
| Ask questions when unsure                  | Don't handle cash or financial transactions         |
| Report concerns to your coordinator        | Don't visit communities alone                       |
| Celebrate small wins with your team        | Don't speak on behalf of SEEWA without approval     |
| Document your activities with photos/notes | Don't impose your views — facilitate, don't dictate |
| Take care of your own well-being           | Don't overcommit — quality over quantity            |

## Key Contacts & Next Steps

| Contact      | Details                                                    | Purpose                       |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| SEEWA Office | +91 96420 76369                                            | General inquiries             |
| Email        | org.seewa@gmail.com                                        | Reports, formal communication |
| WhatsApp     | +91 96420 76369                                            | Daily updates, scheduling     |
| Address      | Manasa Nest, MJ Colony, A.S. Rao Nagar, Hyderabad - 500040 | Office visits                 |
| Website      | seewa.org                                                  | Programs, events, resources   |

### Your Next Steps

- **Today:** Finish reading this guide and the Volunteer Handbook
- **This week:** Join the WhatsApp group and introduce yourself
- **Within 7 days:** Attend your orientation session
- **Within 14 days:** Complete your first shadow activity
- **Ongoing:** Contribute, learn, grow, and make an impact!

#### We're thrilled to have you on board!

Remember — every workshop you facilitate, every entrepreneur you mentor, every child you educate brings us closer to a world where every woman is empowered. Your contribution matters more than you know.

**Welcome to SEEWA. Let's create change together.**

— Dr. Jyothi Para & The SEEWA Team